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BoBA 2026 Pro-Tour Updates and World Championships (at The National) Details

Welcome to BoBA 2026:

We hope you are ready for an exciting year ahead for the Bo Jackson Battle Arena Community. This update is to help clarify a few adjustments for the year ahead and to reveal the much anticipated event schedule for the 2026 World Championships at The National.

We are excited to announce that the 2026 World Championships prize pool now stands at \$500,000+.

The overwhelming support of the BoBA community is the sole reason we are able to offer such prizing in just our second year...so truly...thank you all!

We hope you can join us this year at The National and Regional events across the country.

Given the size of these prize pools we need to cover one very important piece of housekeeping regarding our culture and community expectations.

Yes, the prizes are very big but we will continue to fight for our culture of **fun and camaraderie**.

We will all get the community we deserve and it's worth fighting to make it a good one.

Please be aware that we will aggressively (and unapologetically) remove anyone from events (and any of our spaces) who makes BoBA a "not fun" place to be. We want BoBA to be competitive. But we will fight against those who are toxic. We can't fully describe what that means but (most) all of us know it when we see it.

Again. You CAN be competitive. You can even be VERY competitive. The legacy of Bo Jackson sets our North Star and he sure is competitive!

Just pair being competitive with being kind and respectful to others.

If you come in with a desire to nurture existing friendships, make new ones and have some fun...you've already won...any prize money you take home becomes a nice bonus!

If you come in needing to win money to "cover the trip" and something doesn't go your way...that can quickly become a bad recipe. Fun first. Prize money second. Always.

Thank you for being here. We appreciate you more than you know. With that out of the way...

Let's Bo!

First - Some Important Things to Know:

Introducing "Coaches":

BoBA Players deserve a cool moniker in the gameplay environment. We believe Coach fits perfectly.

So, if you play BoBA, congrats....you now have a title of high esteem...YOU are a coach!

As a Coach, you lead a squad of superheroes into battle. Your Heroes bring the power, but *you* bring the strategy. You decide the roster. You call the Plays. You choose when to push, when to hold, and when to make moves that might swing the game in your direction. Wins are earned by smart decisions, timing, and knowing your team.

The outcome is rarely just about the cards you draw. It is about how you coach them.

FUN FACT: *Even in Rookie Mode...If the decks are evenly matched...it's only impossible to Win or Tie a Game (based on the cards you draw) about 10% of the time. So yes...it's about the Coaching and reading your opponent and the decisions you make.*

Assistant Coaches:

This person sits behind a Coach to assist with gameplay and increase accessibility for younger Coaches and those who might have special needs. Assistant Coaches are allowed in all events unless otherwise specified.

The Assistant Coach rule is NOT intended for otherwise able adults to pair up and look for an edge and anyone abusing the "spirit of the rule" is subject to DQ. Just be kind to each other, use common sense and apply the spirit of this rule and there should never be an issue....but if an issue arises the Head Judge will have broad authority to deal with it as they deem necessary.

Unlimited Versions of a Hero Per Deck:

No more limit on the number of times a HERO can appear in your decks ("one of" for an exact card still applies).

Rookie Mode - Intentional Placement of Heroes is REQUIRED:

When playing rookie mode you must look at your hand. And you must intentionally order your Heroes one by one for battle. You cannot place your cards without looking at them. And you can't look at them and then "shuffle and place them".

We understand this can be a strategy...but it's not consistent with the spirit of Rookie. It can be fun for home/casual play but let's keep it there and not in sanctioned play.

Note: You cannot signal to your opponent in any way that you are randomly placing your heroes or look for an angle to circumvent the spirit of this rule. Judges will have wide discretion to handle violations.

Hero Deck Formats to Know:

Apex Hero Deck Rules:

No power limit. Standard deck rules apply (max 6 Heroes per power).

Spec Hero Deck Rules:

160 power cap. Standard deck rules apply (max 6 Heroes per power).

Elite Hero Deck Rules:

8,250 total power cap for all Heroes in the deck. Starter cards are legal. Trainer cards are NOT legal. Otherwise standard deck rules apply (max 6 Heroes per power).

SPEC+ (Spec Plus) Hero Deck Rules:

SPEC+ uses up to 70 Hero cards.

- 60 Heroes must be 160 power or less (ie a Spec deck). This is the minimum requirement to play.
- Optional: 10 of your Heroes can then be higher power subject to the following limits.
- Only one (1) Hero can be **each** power from 175-200.
- Up to two (2) Heroes can be 165 and 170 power (**each**).
- No Heroes above 200 are allowed in this format.
- Otherwise standard Deck Building Rules apply.

Note: Apex, Spec and SPEC+ Hero deck rules can be used to create Divisions/Brackets in all game modes at The National and other events (Rookie, Substitution and Playmaker).

All Playmaker divisions are 1,000 DBS unless specified otherwise.

Double-Up Add-On (a new twist to know):

Double-Up is a mechanic that can be added to any BoBA Game Mode.

It adds the depth of a *simple* betting and bluffing mechanic to BoBA. It's similar to the doubling cube in backgammon and it's one time use per player per game (meaning each Coach can only double once per game).

Each Game of 7 Battles begins being worth 1 point.

The first Coach to score 7 points wins the match-up.

Each Coach can call a **Press** to double the points available.

Each coach can only Press once per Game.

Opponents may accept the Press (ie the double) or **Fold** to end the current game (or double back if they haven't used their own Press in the current game).

Presses can be called:

- after hands are dealt before placing any Heroes
- and before the start of any subsequent Battles after Battle #1.

This new repeating phase of the game is where you "Do Laundry" (it's a Press & Fold game mechanic and we love a good pun since we aren't serious people).

No Double-Up games can end in a tie. "Top Deck" is in effect as the default tiebreaker where each coach reveals the top card of their Hero deck until a winner is determined.

Laundry Phase Details:

- Coach 1 (the Coach with honors) chooses to Press (Double the points for the Game) or Pass the action to their opponent.
- If Coach 1 Pressed, Coach 2 must then Fold (game ends and Coach 1 gets 1 point); Accept the Press (and the Game will play on for 2 Points) or Press Back.
- If there is a Press Back from Coach 2, Coach 1 must then Fold (award Coach 2 with 2 points because Coach 1 had previously Pressed to raise the points) or Accept the Press and the Game Plays for 4 points.
- If Coach 2 only Accepts the Press, they still have their own Press to use later in the game (to double from 2 to 4 points).
- If Coach 2 Presses later in the Game, Coach 1 must Accept the Press (and continue with the game now worth 4 points) or Fold and award Coach 2 with 2 points (the total active prior to Coach 2's Press).

Madness (Team Play) Details to Know:

“Apex Madness” and “AlphaTrilogy Madness” Hero Deck Rules:

- Head Coach Decks are Full Apex Decks in Standard Madness (60 Hero Cards - 6 per power - no power limit - same Hero/Variation/Power/Weapon combo can't be repeated).
- Head Coach Decks must also include 4 “Full Art Foil Hot Dogs” which should be prominently displayed during all games (ie World Champ Edition style Hot dogs).
- All non-Head Coach decks begin as Spec 160 decks and must earn access to Apex cards with the following *optional optimizations to include up to 10 higher power cards* (other than the Head Coach the rest of the team can play with standard Spec 160 legal Decks if you so choose).
- When a non-Head Coach deck includes 10 of 1 Insert at 160 or Below it unlocks one (1) 165 or higher of that same insert (ie an “Apex Card”)
- So a “Madness Optimized Spec Deck” is able to unlock a total of 6 Apex cards through this method of deck building.
- From there..you can also get 4 more Apex cards by also including 4 different Foil Hot Dogs. Think of these Hot Dogs as the Mascots of your Deck...they should be prominently displayed during all games you play.
- An Optimized Deck can THEN unlock 4 more Apex Cards of Any Type by bringing your 4 favorite Foil Hot Dogs.
- So a final “Maxed Out Madness Deck” = 70 Hero Cards where 60 are Spec power with 10 each of 6 different card types...6 matching Apex cards...and 4 Bonus Apex cards of ANY in-rotation type.
- NOTE: Each Insert type can only unlock 1 APEX card. And Color Battlefoils and Icon Battlefoils are each their own Insert Type (meaning whether you mix the weapons or not within these Insert types, each can only unlock 1 Apex card).
- Supers are wild and can count as ANY insert type

Madness Tiebreaker - If the Teams are tied the Head Coaches (previously the team captains) will play a game and decide the winner. If this game goes to a tie the Head Coaches will “Top Deck” for sudden death until a winner is decided (each reveals the top card of their Hero Deck until a winner is decided).

The Team's Foil Hot Dogs should serve as mascots of sorts and be displayed on the table at all times.

“HiLo Madness” Hero Deck Rules:

- HiLo Madness will normally be used in a format where all Heroes specific Weapon or Inserts.
- Some of the Coaches for each team will play where the highest power wins (High Ball) and some will play where the lowest power wins (Low Ball).
- Usually the Head Coaches will play High Ball and the other 3 Coaches Low Ball (although this may change at various events).
- As is the tradition in Madness, each player must bring 4 of their favorite foil hot dogs to the table to display during games.
- Other deck rules may apply depending on the event (such as power maximums or minimums) as well as the specific weapons and/or card types that can be used.

2026 World Championships at The National:

Each World Championship Division with a cash prize pool gets allocated across the Divisions based on our Prize Pool Share ("PPS") calculation.

You may enter ALL Madness events and a maximum of 1 solo event per Division (as scheduling allows)..

Therefore, for a Division with a Playmaker Event and HiLo Event for solo play you can only enter one or the other.

We will do our best to avoid conflicts for Coaches participating in multiple Divisions but it's possible. If you have 2 Games at the same time you *may* have to choose one to forfeit.

Again, our goal is to avoid conflicts...but they are possible.

Entry fees: All APEX events are FREE to Enter. Entry fees for other events will be posted when registration opens.

In-Rotation Sets

Unless otherwise noted for specific events, all cards released prior to the 2026 National are "In-Rotation" and legal for play.

Cash Payouts & Other Prizes: \$500,000+

Total Prizing for The BoBA 2026 World Championships are estimated to exceed **\$500,000+** with up to \$375,000+ available as CASH PRIZE PAYOUTS (paid via check/wire - no actual cash).

In addition to the posted Cash Payouts and Promo/Prize Cards, winners of solo events with a total prize pool exceeding \$10K will also receive a 2026 Blast Hobby Box (when released).

Winning Madness team Head Coaches will receive 4 Griffey Set Jumbo Boxes (to distribute as the team agrees).

How Prize Pool Shares ("PPS") Work:

Cash Prizes pay out by Division based on our Prize Pool Share ("PPS") Calculation. We will be adding this as a standard addition to the Manuel (not a misspelling) but for now here is the TLDR.

- Each entry in the various Events in a particular Division adds a specific number of Prize Pool Shares ("PPS") to that event.

- Each Event gets allocated its pro-rata share of the Division's cash prize pool based on the total PPS in that Event compared to the Division's other Events.
- From there the Event's share of the Prize pool pays out as published (typically to the Top 8 finishers - but not always).

You will note that all Events have a PPS allocation for each entry the Event receives.

It ***DOES NOT MATTER*** how an Event's PPS compares to the PPS of events in other Divisions. PPS is only relevant compared to other Events in the ***SAME DIVISION***.

2026 World Championships Divisions & Events:

Apex Division - \$150,000

Apex Playmaker:

PPS: 2 Per Entry

- Football Breaker Bojax /99 Auto Needed for Entry
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays ON
- HTD Plays ON
- Apex Deck Rules

Apex Blitz:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- Rookie Mode
- Apex Hero Deck Rules

Apex Madness:

PPS: 7 Per Team Entry

- Football Breaker Bojax /99 Auto Needed for Entry (1 per team)
 - Apex Madness Deck Rules
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AlphaTrilogy Division - \$100,000

AlphaTrilogy Playmaker:

PPS: 2 Per Entry

- Bat Breaker Bojax /99 Auto Needed for Entry
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays ON
- HTD Plays ON
- Apex Deck Rules

AlphaTrilogy Blitz:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- Rookie Mode
- Apex Hero Deck Rules

AlphaTrilogy Madness:

PPS: 7 Per Team Entry

- Bat Breaker Bojax /99 Auto Needed for Entry (1 per team)
 - Apex Madness Deck Rules
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Granny's Gum Division - \$20,000

GG HiLo Madness (Team):

PPS: N/A - 100% to this Single Event

- Team Play. Up to 6 per team. 4 Play at a time.
 - All Heroes must be Grandma's Linoleum, Great Grandma's Linoleum and Bubblegum (Auto or Non-Auto)
 - Hero Decks must contain at least 10 of each legal insert type.
 - Hero Decks have no power cap (Standard deck rules - 6 per power)
 - Head Coaches must play each other in every Match-Up and they will play the traditional way where high power wins.
 - The other Coaches play where ***the lowest power wins***.
 - Head Coaches play "High Ball" and the other coaches play "Low Ball"...this is why we call it "HiLo Madness."
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Open Division - up to \$40,000 (\$20k base cash prize)

Collecting is in our DNA and if you “finish in the money” in any of these Open Division events and your ENTIRE HERO DECK is 1 insert type (Supers can be used as any insert type as they are Wild)...your cash prize will be DOUBLE.

Spec Playmaker:

PPS: 2 Per Entry

- Any in-rotation cards are legal.
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays OFF
- HTD Plays OFF

Elite Playmaker:

PPS: 3 Per Entry

- Any in-rotation cards are legal except Trainers (Starters are legal)
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays ON
- HTD Plays ON
- Otherwise standard deck rules apply (ie. 6 per power level).

SPEC+ Rookie Double-Up:

PPS: 3 Per Entry

- SPEC+ Deck Rules
- Any in-rotation cards are legal.

Blast Division - \$20,000

Blast Substitution Double-Up:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- All cards must be Blast
- Decks only need 30 Heroes for 2026 National
- Limit 3 Heroes Per Power
- All Hot Dogs must be Blast

Blast Substitution Low Ball Double-Up:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- All cards must be Blast
 - Decks only need 30 Heroes for 2026 National
 - Limit 3 Heroes Per Power
 - All Hot Dogs must be Blast
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Brawl Division - \$20,000

Brawl Playmaker

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- No power limit
- All Brawl Weapons
- Otherwise standard deck rules apply (ie. 6 per power level).
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays: OFF
- HTD Plays: OFF
- All Hot Dogs must be "Brawler" (the Hot Dog character's name)

Brawl Rookie Double-Up

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- No power limit
- All Brawl Weapons
- Otherwise standard deck rules apply (ie. 6 per power level)

Brawl HiLo Madness

PPS: 4 Per Entry

- No power limit
 - All Brawl Weapons
 - Standard deck rules apply (ie. 6 per power level)
 - Head Coaches must play each other in every Match-Up and they will play the traditional way where high power wins.
 - The other Coaches play where ***the lowest power wins***.
 - Head Coaches play "High Ball" and the other coaches play "Low Ball"...this is why we call it "HiLo Madness."
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Power Glove Division - \$15,000 (\$10K base - \$5K potential bonus)

Power Glove Set Builder Bracket

PPS: N/A

- Must verify ownership of at least 120 unique Power Glove Inserts
 - All Entrants get a special Promo Card
 - Winner gets a \$5,000 Bonus if they verified ownership of a Full Power Glove set
 - Play with any 60 of your Power Glove Inserts
 - Standard deck rules apply (ie. 6 per power level)
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Tecmo Bowl Division - \$50,000

All cards must come from the Tecmo Bowl Set.

Tecmo Bowl SPEC+ Playmaker:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- SPEC+ Deck Rules
- ALL cards must be from the Tecmo Bowl Set
- 1,000 DBS
- Bonus Plays are ON (Tecmo Only)
- HTD Plays are N/A (None in Tecmo)

SPEC+ Rookie Double-Up:

PPS: 1 Per Entry

- SPEC+ Deck Rules
- Tecmo Heroes Only

Tecmo Bowl HiLo Madness (Team):

PPS: 3 Per Entry

- Team Play. Up to 6 per team. 4 Play at a time.
 - All Cards must be from the Tecmo Bowl Set
 - Hero Decks have no power cap (Standard deck rules - 6 per power)
 - Head Coaches must play each other in every Match-Up and they will play the traditional way where high power wins.
 - The other Coaches play where ***the lowest power wins.***
 - Head Coaches play "High Ball" and the other coaches play "Low Ball"...this is why we call it "HiLo Madness."
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